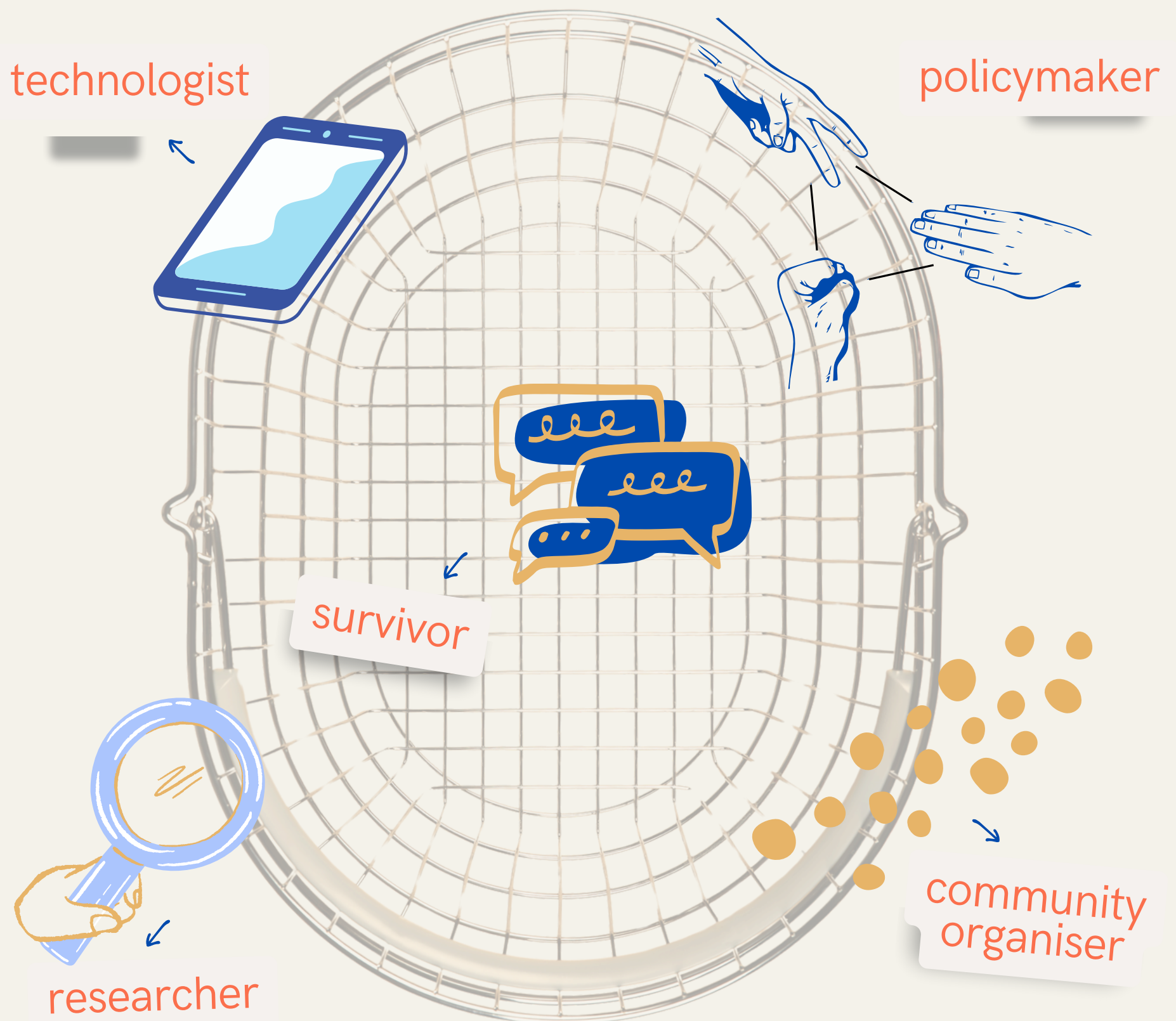


Online Gendered Abuse Advocacy Toolkit



WHO ARE YOU?

Select the role that best describes you
and then use these prompts to guide
how to use the toolkit:

**WHO DO YOU WORK
WITH?**

**WHAT ARE THEIR
REALITIES?**

WHAT CAN YOU CHANGE?

technologist

When a platform detects misogynistic content, whose voice is centre: the tech team, the community, or the survivor?



In India, transgender women were found to be at heightened risk of online harassment compared to cisgender women.

Checkpoint:

Audit your platform's moderation policies: Are terms of service gender-neutral or gender-aware?

Resource:

Uli Dataset – dataset of Indic-language gendered abuse, useful for training detection systems.

key approaches for a technologist

Online misogyny often remains hidden because platforms don't surface it, data is fragmented, and normalizes bias against minoritized voices.

For example, a study of Indian Twitter data found online misogyny rising but under-reported in many cases.

▶ **Research Question:** "Which forms of misogyny (language, context, caste/gender minority) are invisible in your platform logs?"

▶ *Approach:* Develop log filters and labels for under-detected abuse (e.g., code-mixed insults, masked image-based abuse) and visualise gaps.

▶ **Research Question:** "How will survivors or community members validate whether your data capture reflects their lived experience?"

▶ *Approach:* build participatory modules where survivors/community users can tag content, verify false-negatives, and feed into model training.

▶ **Research Question:** "Does your dashboard break down abuse by region, language, gender identity, caste/class markers?"

▶ *Approach:* design UI components that show layered filters: e.g., "Abuse flagged in Tamil, female-speaker, caste-minority context" and chart trends.

Policymaker

Which institutions have power in online-misogyny cases (cyber cells, platforms, courts, community groups)?

A survey found gender and sexual minorities in India often don't report online harassment. Norms and fear of surveillance limit voices.



Checkpoint:

Create participatory platforms where survivors and community actors feed into policy design (not just expert hearings).



Resource:

Exploring the Dynamics of Negotiating Everyday Sexism in India - helps root online policy in everyday experiences.

Policymaker: Key Approaches

Policies often erase lived experiences through bureaucratic or gender-neutral framing. Visibility means surfacing unseen realities, like caste, class, sexuality, rural access, in data and law.



Research question: Which groups' realities remain absent in your data or deliberations?

Require cybercrime cells and ministries to report data disaggregated by gender, caste, region, and language.



Research question: How can survivor narratives inform measurable policy change?

Institutionalize community consultations (Dalit, queer, and rural women's collectives).



Research question: How can survivor narratives inform measurable policy change?

Develop public dashboards tracking implementation gaps (e.g., FIRs filed, cases resolved).



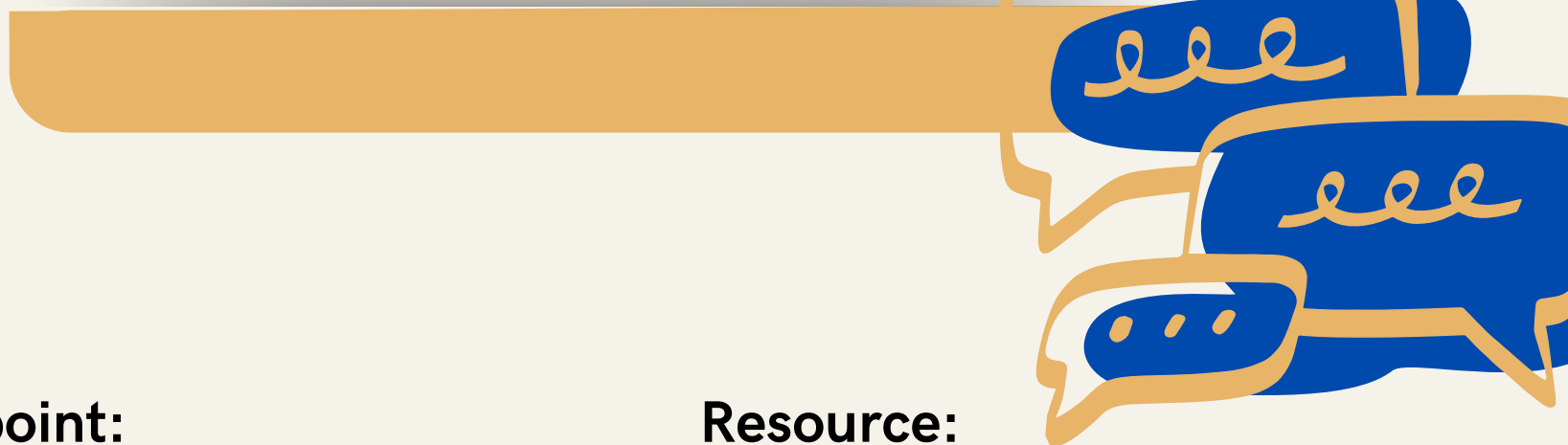


Survivor

Who gets to decide what counted as harassment?



Short-form video platforms in India often do not name misogyny explicitly in guidelines, creating confusion and under-reporting.



Checkpoint:

Use a “Post-incident reflection template”: record emotional, digital, relational impacts (online→offline).

Resource:

Definitions & types of digital abuse (trolling, doxing, image-based abuse) from UN Women FAQ.



Survivor's approaches are key

Most survivors' experiences are filtered through institutions or media. Visibility is about reclaiming the right to define harm and response.

Research question: What forms of abuse remain unnamed or misinterpreted?

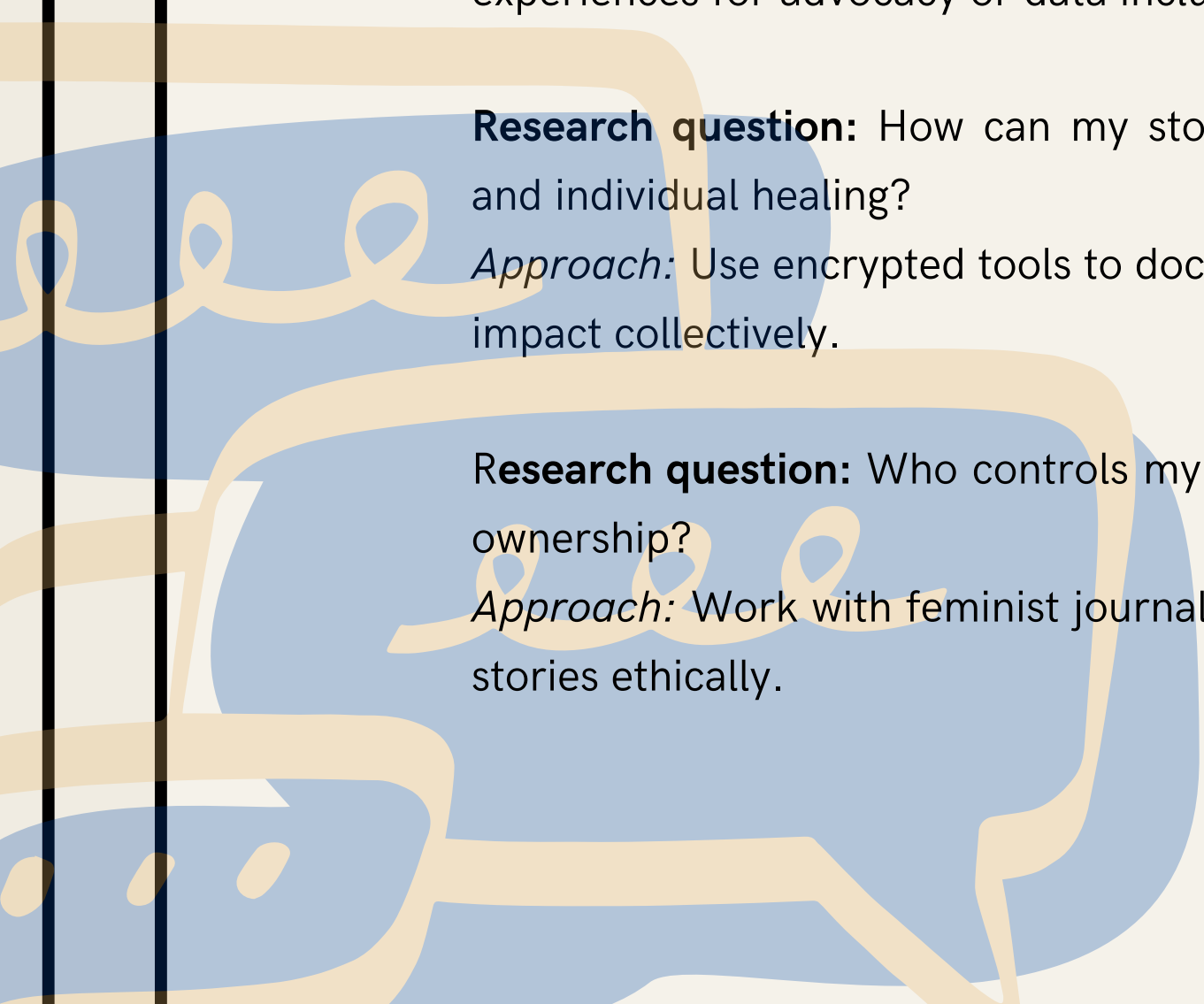
Approach: Safe spaces for survivors to narrate and anonymize their experiences for advocacy or data inclusion.

Research question: How can my story contribute to both systemic and individual healing?

Approach: Use encrypted tools to document evidence, metadata, and impact collectively.

Research question: Who controls my evidence, and how can I retain ownership?

Approach: Work with feminist journalists, digital-rights groups to tell stories ethically.





Researcher

Whose knowledge is considered valid in this field?
Are survivor-voices centered or only 'expert'
voices?

**Some gender minorities don't see
themselves as 'survivors or victims'
hence leading to under-reporting.**

Checkpoint:

Reflect on power in research:
Who defines research questions?
Who holds data? Who benefits
from results?

Resource:

How do we study misogyny in
the digital age? A systematic
review by Nature showing key
terms, gaps in research.

Researcher's key approaches

Academic and data ecosystems often reproduce privilege: English-language, urban, male-centric samples. Visibility means valuing plural knowledges.

Research Question: What remains unmeasured because of language or platform bias?

Approach: Collect data in regional languages, podcasts, or oral testimonies.

Research Question: Are marginalized communities visible as data producers?

Approach: Invite survivors as co-researchers; credit them in authorship.

Research Question: How can findings reach communities who inform them?

Approach: Translate findings into policy briefs or community zines beyond journals.



Community *Organizer*

In your community work, whose agency is central? Is it the survivors, the community organiser, the funder or the platform?

Activists in India felt they had to tailor their online presence to avoid backlash or surveillance.

Checkpoint:

Map your local institutional ecosystem: which cyber-cells, legal aid, mental health services exist? How accessible are they for your community?

Resource:

All India Dalit Mahila Adhikar Manch is an example of caste-gender community organising for women's dignity.

Community *Organizer:* *Approaches*

Grassroots work often remains invisible to state or digital systems. Making it visible means archiving and scaling care as political infrastructure.

Research Question: What alliances can expand visibility without diluting autonomy?

Approach: Connect gender, labor, climate, and caste-justice spaces through shared storytelling.

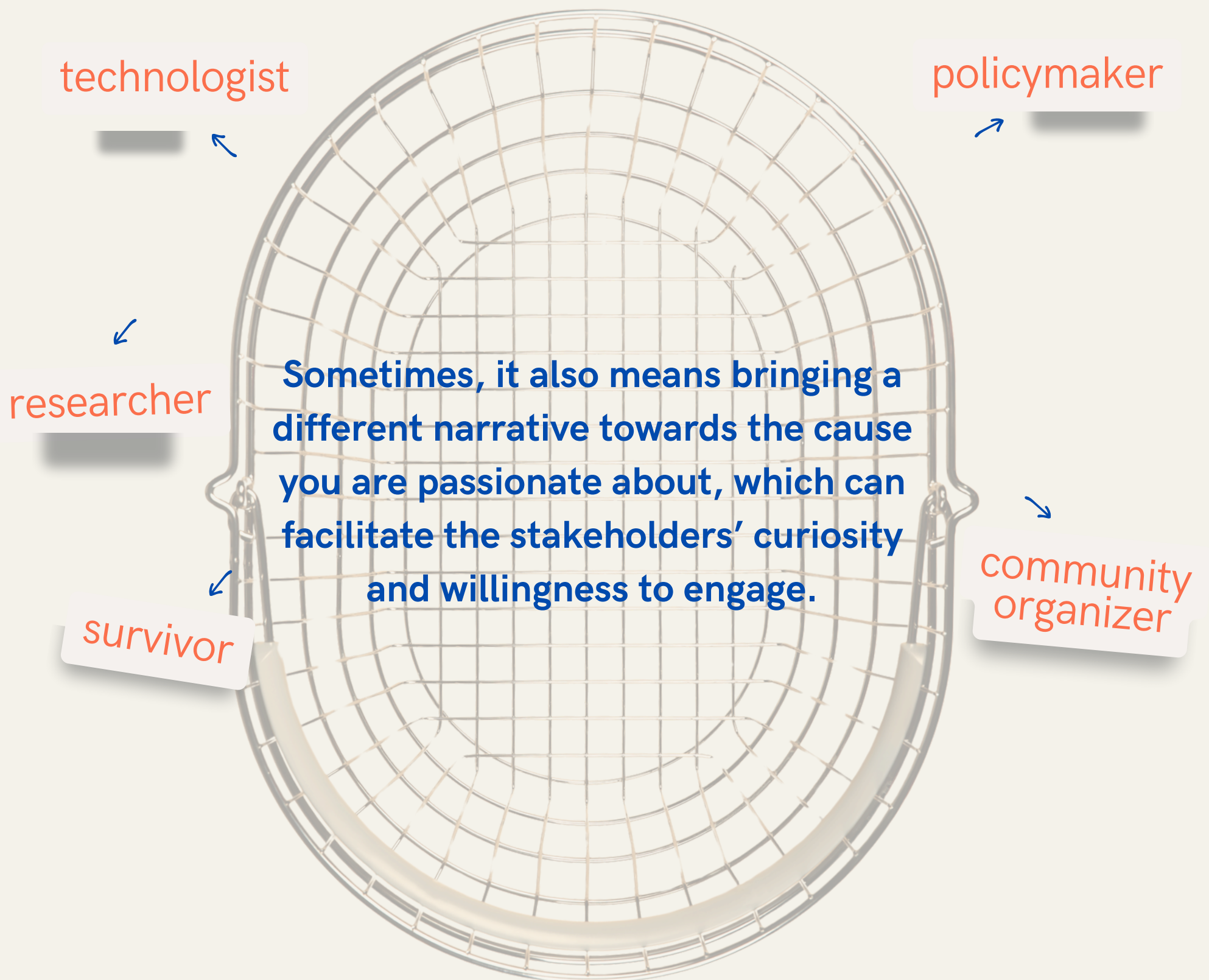
Research Question: Whose everyday labor keeps communities safe?

Approach: Publicly document local interventions (workshops, legal aid, digital-safety pods).

Research Question: What alliances can expand visibility without diluting autonomy?

Approach: Map where decision-making lies in digital safety networks, then strategize coalition leverage.

Working in a system requires continuous alignment and negotiation with multiple actors.



The key question then would be: How do you advocate from your point of reference?



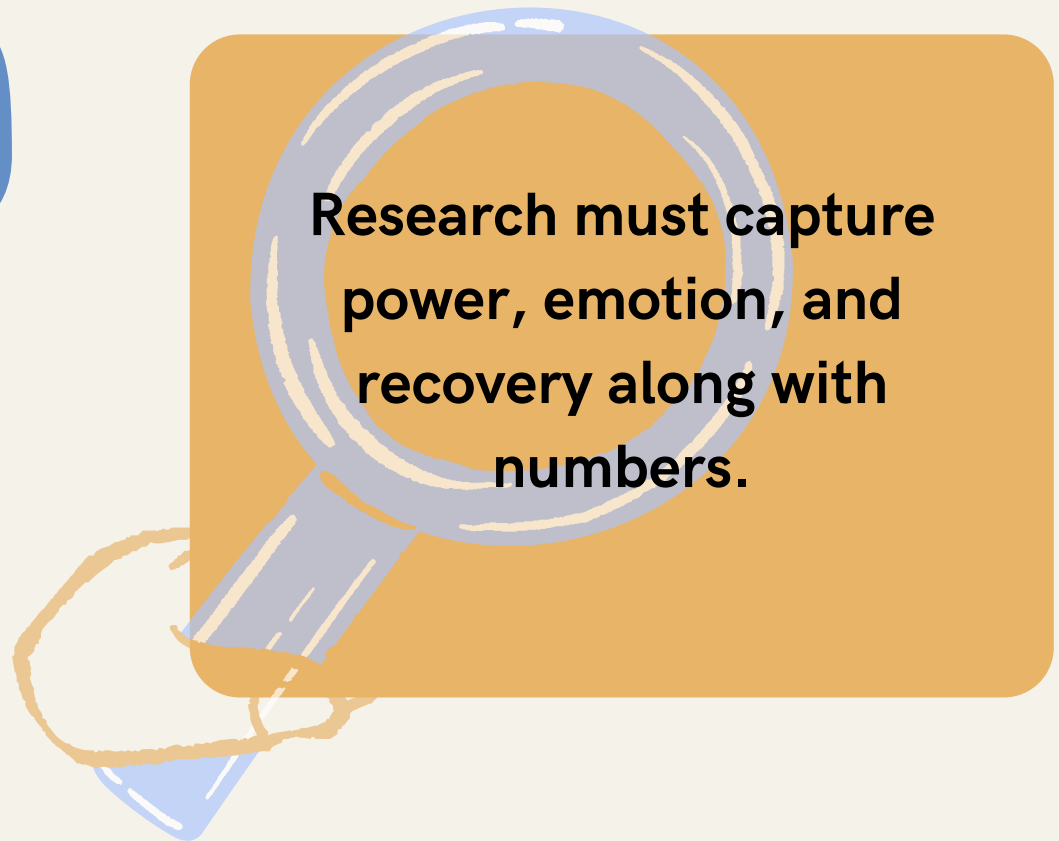
**Technology is never
neutral; inclusion begins
in choices made during
building the architecture.**



**Policy impact grows when
informed by those
navigating its dead-ends.**



**Sharing lived experience
can shift narratives and
redefine accountability.**



**Research must capture
power, emotion, and
recovery along with
numbers.**

**Sustainable change grows
when we transform our
approach from individual
protection to collective
accountability.**



How a technologist can advocate to....



Policymaker

Translate platform data into clear evidence of harm; show how design changes need legal backing for accountability.

Survivor

Co-design safety features; create accessible reporting & privacy tools that honor consent and autonomy.

Researcher

Share anonymised datasets for ethical study; invite them to stress-test bias and false negatives.

Community Organizer

Build tools that work in low-tech, multilingual, marginalised contexts; adapt features from field feedback.

How a policymaker can advocate to...

Technologist

Set standards for transparency, safety-by-design & reporting; incentivise ethical design over engagement metrics.

Survivor

Create safe, survivor-led policy consultations and redress mechanisms that center lived experience.

Researcher

Fund intersectional research and require findings to inform policy drafts, monitoring and evaluation.

Community Organizer

Channel resources to grassroots collectives; formalise community-based care models into public programs.

How a survivor can advocate to...

Technologist

Share usability pain points & harm patterns; push for safer defaults and trauma-informed UX.

Policymaker

Offer testimony to expose policy blind spots; advocate for intersectional legal recognition of online harm.

Researcher

Guide research questions toward real harms, emotional impact, and recovery pathways beyond incident counts.

Community Organizer

Build peer support circles; co-lead healing and advocacy spaces that turn personal stories into collective strength.

How a researcher can advocate to...

Technologist

Provide evidence of what tech misses (languages, caste, queer contexts); recommend ethical model improvements.

Policymaker

Translate findings into simple, actionable briefs; highlight gaps in implementation and equity.

Survivor

Return findings accessibly (not extractively); equip survivors with knowledge to navigate systems.

Community Organizer

Co-create knowledge with communities; help convert data into campaigns and local action.

How a community organizer can advocate to...

Technologist

Bring real-world stories/language samples so design reflects lived realities, not assumptions.

Policymaker

Pressure for response protocols that work on the ground; demonstrate community-tested models of care.

Survivor

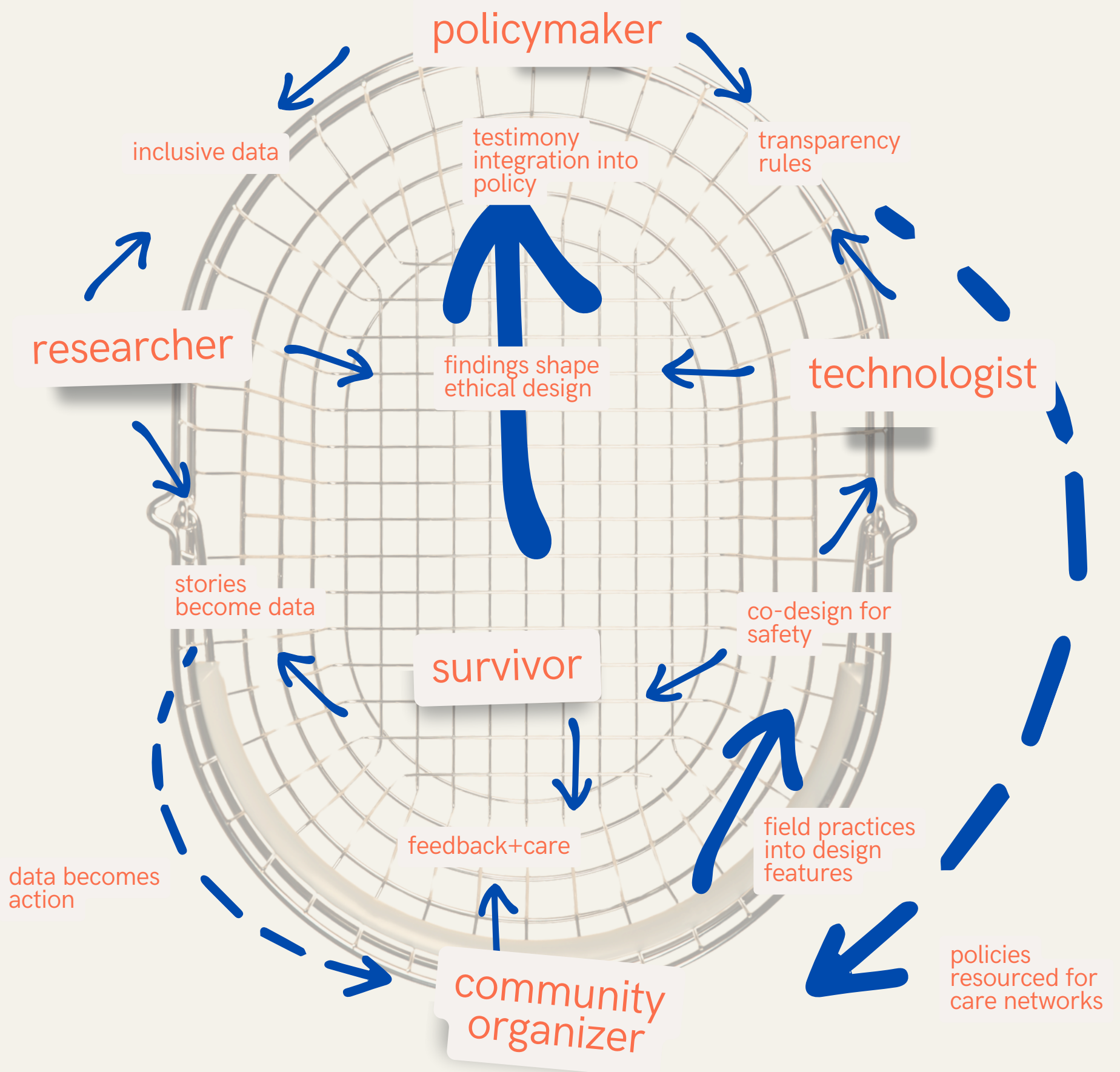
Provide safe spaces, collective care, and pathways for survivors to lead advocacy.

Researcher

Inform research priorities with ground needs; ensure research outputs return to communities in usable form.

Digital Ecosystem

points of impact



Acknowledgements



A note

This toolkit is intended as a guide to inform your advocacy approach. We recognise that contexts differ, and some elements may not fully apply to your environment.

Our intention is to offer as broad and adaptable a resource as possible, while remaining grounded in lived realities.

We welcome reflections, feedback, and experiences that can help strengthen and evolve this toolkit in future iterations.

Your insights are part of this ongoing collective process.

**Please write to
hameeda@dignityindifference.org if
you have any insights.**

References

Tier 1: India (must-reads)

- ICRW/USAID: TFGBV in India: concise landscape & gaps. [Policy/Research] ([ICRW](#))
- CIS: oGBV on Short-Form Video Platforms: policy & UX audits. [Tech/Policy] ([cis-india.org](#))
- CIGI: The Cost of Transgression (India): intersectional evidence. [Policy/Research] ([cigionline.org](#))
- Equality Now: Experiencing TFGBV in India: survivor-led findings. [Survivor/Policy] ([Equality Now](#))

Tier 2: Global/Regional (context)

- IPU: 60% of women MPs in Asia-Pacific face online GBV: stats, recs. [Policy] ([Inter-Parliamentary Union](#))
- UN Women: TFGBV FAQs: definitions, responses. [All] ([UN Women](#))
- Nature (HSSC): Systematic review of online misogyny : methods & gaps. [Research/Tech] ([Nature](#))
- Guardian: Algorithms amplify misogyny: platform risk signal. [Tech/Policy] ([The Guardian](#))

References

Tier 3: Tools, datasets, frameworks

- HASOC 2019 (Hindi/EN): hate/offense datasets.
[Tech/Research] ([hasocfire.github.io](https://github.com/hasocfire))
- Hindi-English Aggression Corpus (LREC'18).
[Tech/Research] ([ACL Anthology](https://aclanthology.org/))
- Safecity (Red Dot Foundation): crowdsourced harassment maps. [Community/Policy]
(webapp.safecity.in)
- Tattle: civic-tech tools on harmful content.
[Tech/Community] (tattle.co.in)